



In good touch: Yashasvi Jaiswal, who recently became the fastest Indian to reach 1000 runs as an opener in men's Tests, would like to carry that form into this year's IPL. SPORTZPICS/IPL

struggled to dominate the batting charts since 2017.

RCB

In the RCB camp, Kohli and Faf du Plessis form a dynamic opening duo. The 2023 season's most successful pair scored 939 runs in 14 innings, with five 50-plus and three 100-plus partnerships.

The ever-batting-dependent RCB will need its opening pair to fire once more. **However, concerns linger over Du Plessis' recent form — he managed 239 in 11 innings —**

highlighted by his inconsistent performances in the SA20 Championship and the inactivity of the former Indian captain, who has only played two T20s after IPL 2023. Yet, their experience and familiarity with Bengaluru's conditions make them indispensable to RCB's aspirations.

GT

As for Gujarat Titans, the Orange Cap holder in IPL 2023, Shubman Gill, shoulders the responsibility of steering the team in the absence of Hardik. **With the T20 World Cup approaching, the 24-year-old faces the daunting task of shepherding the back-to-back finalist with both bat and as captain.** Teaming up with Wriddhiman Saha, who has found renewed confidence in the top order, he provides stability to the

Overcoming lean patch: Freed from the captaincy responsibilities — as Hardik Pandya takes over the reins for MI this season — Rohit Sharma is expected to lead the charge with the bat this year. GETTY IMAGES

Titans' batting lineup. The pair added 590 runs at a 145.32 strike rate in IPL 2023.

DC

Delhi Capitals relies on the explosive combination of David Warner and Prithvi Shaw at the top. Warner's batting approach will be facilitated by the return of regular captain Rishabh Pant, allowing him to start on an attacking note. Shaw, after a decent domestic season, looks to make an impact from the outset, aiming to provide solid starts